CASE STUDY: PHISHING ATTACK

Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted entity. A common example is when a user receives an email or message that appears to be from a bank or a well-known company.

In a typical phishing attack, the process begins with the attacker sending a fake message that looks legitimate. This message often contains a link directing the user to a fraudulent website that closely resembles the original one. When the user enters their login credentials or financial details, the attacker captures this information. In some cases, the attacker may also ask for OTPs to complete unauthorized transactions.

Students, elderly people, and individuals who are less aware of digital security are often targeted. Busy professionals may also fall victim due to lack of attention.

The consequences can be severe, including financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorized access to personal accounts. Victims may also experience stress and loss of trust in online systems.

Such incidents can be prevented by verifying the sender, avoiding suspicious links, using secure websites, and never sharing sensitive information online.